

Day 2: Power BI Desktop Interface & Navigation

📌 Definition to Remember

Power BI Desktop Interface provides a streamlined 3-view development environment (Report View, Table/Data View, and Model View) along with dedicated panes for Visualizations, Data Fields, Filters, and Format controls.

1. The Three Primary Workspace Views

1. **Report View (Canvas):** The visual design canvas where charts, cards, slicers, and interactive elements are arranged.
2. **Table / Data View:** Data grid view used to inspect underlying raw tables, preview column values, and verify calculated columns.
3. **Model View (Relationship Canvas):** Diagrammatic canvas used to define primary/foreign key relationships, set cardinality (1:*), and configure cross-filter directions.

2. Essential Development Panes

- **Data / Fields Pane:** Lists all imported tables, columns, hierarchies, and DAX measures.
- **Visualizations Pane:** Library of native chart types (Bar, Line, Matrix, Scatter, etc.) and visual property configuration.
- **Format Pane:** Precision formatting controls (colors, fonts, data labels, tooltips, conditional formatting).
- **Filters Pane:** Three scoping tiers:
 1. *Visual-level filters:* Affect only the selected chart.
 2. *Page-level filters:* Affect all visuals on the current page.
 3. *Report-level filters:* Affect all visuals across all report pages.

3. Report Canvas Formatting & Global Themes

- **Canvas Sizing:** Standard 16:9 widescreen (1280x720 or 1920x1080) vs Custom tooltip size.
- **JSON Theme Files:** Applying enterprise branding color palettes, typography, and default chart borders across the entire `.pbix` file.

★ Must-Master Skills & Interview Points

1. Know how to switch between Report, Table, and Model views.
2. Understand the hierarchical evaluation order of visual, page, and report filters.
3. Master canvas alignment, snap-to-grid, and grouping objects in the Selection Pane.

⚡ Quick Recall

Report View (Canvas) + Table View (Data inspection) + Model View (Relationships) + 3 Filter Tiers (Visual, Page, Report)

